

AGRICULTURAL STUDIES

Overview

The agricultural studies curriculum has two options, production and management and multidisciplinary. Graduates are prepared for careers in production agriculture and agricultural industry. Graduates accept positions in agricultural business, industry, agencies, and production agriculture.

Student Learning Outcomes

Graduates will have a broad base of agricultural knowledge, and will be skilled in decision making, planning, organizing, presenting, and evaluating information. Through the successful completion of the required coursework, active participation in clubs and organizations, and the acquisition of technical skills and experiences associated with work experiences, internships, and international travel, graduates of our baccalaureate programs meet the university, college, and departmental outcomes in the following nine areas:

1. Professional, interpersonal, and cross-cultural communications
2. Problem solving and critical thinking
3. Leadership
4. Entrepreneurship
5. Life-long learning
6. Ethics
7. Environmental awareness
8. U.S. cultures and communities
9. International perspectives.

More information regarding the departmental learning outcomes can be found at www.ageds.iastate.edu/. (<http://www.ageds.iastate.edu/>)

Accreditation

Iowa State University is accredited by the Higher Learning Commission (HLC), a commission of the North Central Association of Colleges and Schools.

Explore More

For more information on the undergraduate major in Agricultural Studies, please visit:

- <https://www.cals.iastate.edu/major/agricultural-studies> (<https://www.cals.iastate.edu/major/agricultural-studies/>)
- <https://www.ageds.iastate.edu/undergraduate/agricultural-studies> (<https://www.ageds.iastate.edu/undergraduate/agricultural-studies/>)

Contact Information

Primary Contact

- **Name:** Undergraduate Programs
- **Email:** agedsinfo@iastate.edu
- **Location:** 201 Curtiss Hall
- **Phone Number:** (515) 294-5872

College Website

- <https://www.cals.iastate.edu/>

Department Website

- <https://www.ageds.iastate.edu/>

Program Administration

- **Owning Academic Unit/College:** College of Agriculture and Life Sciences
- **Coordinating Academic Unit/Department:** Department of Agricultural Education and Studies

Credential Opportunities

- **Program Duration:** 4 years
- **Credential(s) Offered:** Agricultural Studies, B.S. (120 credits)
- **Program Focus Areas:**
 - **Multidisciplinary Undergraduate Program Focus:** This program focus requires students to select three emphasis areas (at least two from the College of Agriculture and Life Sciences), complete university- and college requirements, as well as field-based experiences. It provides students with the opportunities to focus on the agriculture areas of their choice and complement these emphasis areas with experiences and free electives - allowing them to expand their knowledge base and learn topics they might not have the time to study otherwise. (120 credits)
 - **Production and Management Undergraduate Program Focus:** This program focus covers the broad spectrum of agriculture and life sciences with the flexibility for you to customize the major to pursue your career goals. This program focus includes a foundation of coursework in agronomy, animal science, agricultural business, natural resources, farm operation, and agricultural law. Then, students use a large number of free electives to personalize their remaining coursework through minors or targeted coursework in their interest areas. With a solid background in agriculture and life sciences, you are prepared for a career in many areas of agriculture from production agriculture to extension to agribusiness. The quality and flexibility of the program make this a popular major for

incoming high school students as well as transfer students from community colleges. (120 credits)

- **Available as an Additional Major:** Yes, Agricultural Studies, B.S. can either be taken as a primary program of study leading to a single degree credential of Bachelor of Science, or it can be pursued as an additional major in conjunction with another primary program of study and its respective degree credential.
- **Program Limitations:** There are no additional program limitations beyond the rules regarding degree planning (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>).
- **Program Designation:** On-Campus Program

Curriculum in Agricultural Studies

Administered by the Department of Agricultural Education and Studies. Students are encouraged to develop one or more areas of concentration in agricultural sciences and economics.

Production and Management Option

Total Degree Requirement: 120 cr.

Only 65 cr. from a two-year institution may apply which may include up to 16 technical cr.; 9 P-NP cr. of free electives; 2.00 minimum GPA.

University Requirements:

ENGL 1500	Critical Thinking and Communication	3
ENGL 2500	Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition	3
International Perspectives from approved list		3
LIB 1600	Introduction to College Level Research	1
U.S. Cultures and Communities from approved list		3
Total Credits		13

CALS Requirements

Communications Proficiency:

6 cr. of English composition with a C or better and 3 cr. of speech fundamentals with a C or better.

AGEDS 3110	Presentation and Sales Strategies for Agricultural Audiences	3
BIOL 1010	Introductory Biology	3
or BIOL 2110	Principles of Biology I	
CHEM 1630	College Chemistry	4
CHEM 1630L	Laboratory in College Chemistry	1
ECON 1010	Principles of Microeconomics	3
Ethics Elective from approved list		3
Humanities Elective from approved list		3
Life Science elective from approved list		3
MATH 1400	College Algebra	3

STAT 1040	Introduction to Statistics	3
Total Credits		29

Major Requirements

ACCT 2840	Financial Accounting	3
AGEDS 1100	Professional Development in Agricultural Education and Studies: New Student Seminar	1
AGEDS 2150	Professional Development in Agricultural Education and Studies: Career Seminar	1
AGEDS 3150	Personal, Professional, and Entrepreneurial Leadership in Agriculture	3
AGEDS 3270	Survey of Agriculture and Life Sciences Communication	3
AGEDS 4500	Farm Management and Operation	3
AGEDS 4510	Agricultural Law	3
AGRON 1810	Introduction to Crop Science	3
AGRON 1820	Introduction to Soil Science	3
AGRON 2800	Crop Development, Production and Management	3
ANS 1010	Working with Animals	2
ANS 1140	Survey of the Animal Industry	2
And 6 credit hours from ANS, any level or approved list		6
ECON 2300	Farm Business Management	3
ECON 2350	Introduction to Agricultural Markets	3
Econ 3000 Level from Department Approved List		3
NREM 1200	Introduction to Renewable Resources	3
or NREM 1300 Natural Resources and Agriculture		

Total Credits		48
----------------------	--	-----------

Other Required Course:

Electives: Select courses to get to 120 credits.

No more than 4 cr. of or 3970 may count toward graduation.

No more than 6 cr. of 4900 may count toward graduation.

Multidisciplinary Option

Total Degree Requirement: 120 cr.

Only 65 cr. from a two-year institution may apply which may include up to 16 technical cr.; 9 P-NP cr. of free electives; 2.00 minimum GPA.

University Requirements

ENGL 1500	Critical Thinking and Communication	3
ENGL 2500	Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition	3
LIB 1600	Introduction to College Level Research	1
International Perspective from approved list		3
U.S. Cultures and Communities from approved list		3
Total Credits		13

CALS Requirements**Communications Proficiency:**

6 cr. of English composition with a C or better and 3 cr. of speech fundamentals with a C or better.

BIOL 1010	Introductory Biology	3
or BIOL 2110	Principles of Biology I	
Ethics Elective from approved list		3
Humanities Elective from approved list		3
Life Science Elective from approved list		3
MATH 1400	College Algebra	3
Physical Science Elective from approved list		5
Speech Elective from approved list		3
Social Science Elective from approved list		3
STAT 1040	Introduction to Statistics	3
Total Credits		29

Major Requirements**Agriculture and Life Sciences Core**

AGEDS 1100	Professional Development in Agricultural Education and Studies: New Student Seminar	1
AGEDS 2150	Professional Development in Agricultural Education and Studies: Career Seminar	1
6 credits of Approved AGEDS Credits		6
AGEDS 4600	Capstone in Agricultural Studies - Multidisciplinary Option	3
Select one CALS area, including 6 credits at 3000-4000 level taken at Iowa State *		15
Select one CALS area, including 6 credits at 3000-4000 level taken at Iowa State *		15
Select one other area, including 6 credits at 3000-4000 level taken at Iowa State *		15
Total Credits		56

* An individual course may only apply towards one area.

Other Required Course:

Electives: Select courses to get to 120 credits.

Preveterinary Studies

Preparation for admission to veterinary medicine may be accomplished through the agricultural studies curriculum.

Agricultural Studies, B.S.

Any four year plans shared in this catalog are samples of a potential university experience.

Production and Management Option

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
AGEDS 1100	1 ANS 1140	2
ECON 1010	3 AGRON 1820	3
NREM 1200 or 1300	3 ANS 1010	2
MATH 1400	3 STAT 1040	3
ENGL 1500	3 ENGL 2500	3
LIB 1600	1 Humanities Elective	3
AGRON 1810	3	
	17	16

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
BIOL 1010	3 Life Science Elective	3
AGRON 2800	3 U.S. Cultures and Communities Elective	3
Intl Perspective Elective	3 ANS Elective	3
ECON 2350	3 Elective	3
ACCT 2840	3 AGEDS 2150	1
	15	13

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ANS Elective	3 AGEDS 3110	3
AGEDS 3150	3 ECON 2300	3
CHEM 1630	4 Ethics Elective	3
CHEM 1630L	1 Elective	7
Elective	6	
	17	16

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
AGEDS 4500	3 AGEDS 4510	3
AGEDS 3270	3 Elective	11
Econ Elective - Select from Approved List	3	
Elective	3	
	12	14

Total Credits: 120

Agricultural Studies, B.S.

Any four year plans shared in this catalog are samples of a potential university experience.

Multidisciplinary Option

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500	3 BIOL 1010	3
AGEDS 1100	1 ENGL 2500	3
LIB 1600	1 International Perspectives	3
MATH 1400	3 Humanities Elective	3
Area Course	3 Area Course	3
Social Science Elective	3	
	14	15

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
Free Elective	4 Free Elective	6
Area Course	3 Area Course	3
Area Course	3 Area Course	3
Physical Science Elective	5 U.S. Cultures and Communities Elective	3
	AGEDS 2150	1
	15	16

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
AGEDS 3150	3 Speech Elective	3
STAT 1040	3 Area Course	3
Ethics Elective	3 Area Course	3
Area Course	3 Area Course	3
Free Elective	3 Free Elective	3
	15	15

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
Free Elective	3 Free Elective	6
Life Science Elective	3 Area Course	3
Area Course	3 Area Course	3
Area Course	3 AGEDS 4600	3
Area Course	3	
	15	15

Total Credits: 120

* A 2.00 grade point average is required.